

Questions for Sidra : ואתחנן

1. What does Mosheh Rabbeinu say will make the Nations of the World acknowledge that we are “a wise and understanding people”?
2. Besides the actual laws that are contained in the Decalogue (“the Ten Commandments”) what else does Mosheh Rabbeinu say we learned at Mount Sinai?
3. Why is it that the Nations of the World are permitted to revere other gods so long as they acknowledge HaShem as the G-d of all gods, but we may not?
4. What message do you think is intended from the fact that Mosheh Rabbeinu warns us about being exiled from our Land even before we have set foot in the place?
5. In this week’s Sidra is the Mitzvah to love HaShem. (The second Possuk of the first paragraph of the Shema.) But why is it necessary to love HaShem as well as to fear Him?
6. Which is the very first Possuk that a father is commanded to teach his child just as soon as he starts to talk? (It’s in this week’s Sidra.) Which is it?
7. What noteworthy differences are there between the Luchos as described in Sidra Yisro and the Luchos as they are described in this week’s Sidra? How do you reconcile those differences?
8. Why, do you think, are just these commandments out of the 613 Mitzvos of the Torah, listed as the Ten Commandments? After all, are there not other Mitzvos which could be said to be just as important as the Ten Commandments?
9. Why, do you think, is Shabbos “the Foundation of Faith”?
10. Why, do you think, did HaShem allow foreigners to occupy Erets Yisroel while we were absent in Egypt? Wouldn’t have been easier for us if the country would have been empty of inhabitants and we would have been able to take possession without fighting for it?
11. Does the Torah allow any old idols (that have lost their worshippers) to be kept in Erets Yisroel (for instance in a National Museum) as a historical record of what once was?

Question for Haftarah ואתחנן

12. What is the connexion between the Sidra and this Haftarah?